

FIREMAN'S HANDBOOK

34.11d - Locating and Identifying Smokes

1. Looking for Smoke. Observations for smoke, can be best obtained from a combination of general and intensive methods.

General observations are an extensive survey of the entire country instead of an intensive look at any particular point. Knowledge of the country will enable a fireman to pick out instantly anything unusual.

General observations are made continuously during daylight hours in the following manner: make a systematic slow scanning of the entire seen area (figure 1); do not actually look on any particular point unless attracted by something unusual. Spend more time in scanning areas of high risks such as logging operations, camping areas, fishing streams, and well traveled roads, but do not overlook or skip areas of low risk or little use. Following lightning storms, thoroughly scan areas with strikes.

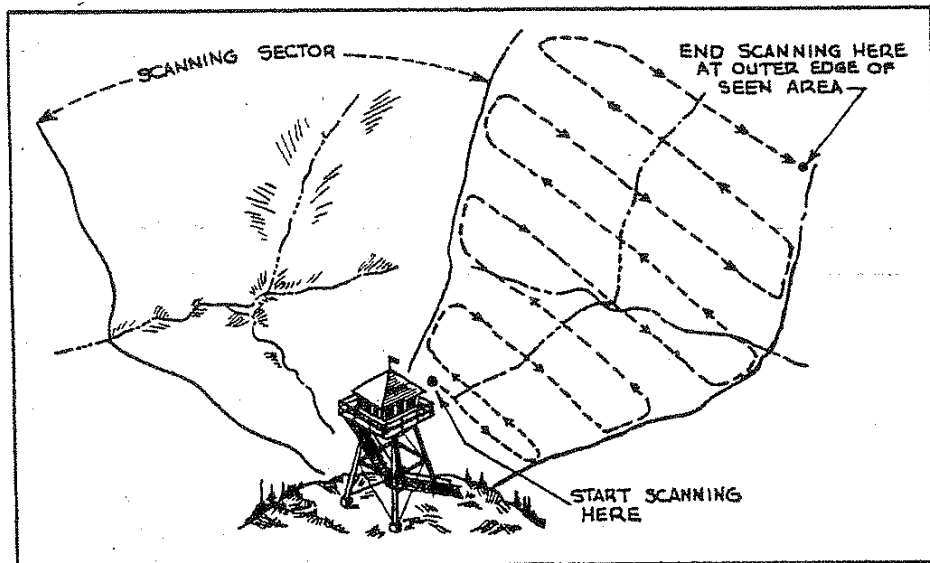


Figure 1. --Systematic method of searching for smoke.

Make intensive observations at 15-minute intervals during daylight hours in the following manner: divide the entire seen area into units or sectors with readily recognized boundaries. Use ridges and drainages as boundary markers or use the firefinder to form sectors of about 45 degrees (45°) each. These sectors must be small enough to allow thorough examination without too much shifting of the eye. Start the intensive search in the same place each time and progress